

India wants Facebook, Google to monitor user content

The Indian government wants operators of social networks, including Facebook and Google, to start monitoring user content and remove any offensive material that is hateful, threatening, incites violence or contains nudity. Indian Telecom Minister, Kapil Sibal recently

images and statements which they didn't adhere to.

The minister also denied a New York Times report which said that the government wants to "censor" user content. "This is far from the truth. If someone doesn't want to remove this kind of incendiary material then the government has to do something about it," said Sibal.

While Facebook agrees, Google India took an altogether different stance, with its history of liberal principles:

"We work really hard to make sure that people have as much access to information as possible, while also following the law. This means that when content is illegal, we abide by local law and take it down. When content is legal but controversial we don't remove it because people's differing views should be respected, so long as they are legal." **d**



met officials of the internet companies, including Yahoo and Microsoft, asking them to set up a monitoring mechanism.

Talking to reporters, Sibal revealed that he had asked the internet companies in September to remove offensive

Microsoft Internet Explorer to get auto-updates from January

Microsoft will begin rolling out silent auto-updates to Internet Explorer across platforms in January, beginning with Australia and Brazil. This will allow the company to finally make users upgrade their Internet Explorer to the latest version available for their operating system.

In other words, Windows XP users still on IE6 or IE7 will be auto-updated to IE8; Windows Vista and 7 users still using IE8 will be auto-updated to IE9.

The auto-update will require. Automatic Windows Update to be turned on however, and users won't be forced to move, with Microsoft also announcing IE8 and IE9 Automatic Update Blocker toolkits to stop auto-updates. Users can uninstall the latest auto-update at any point.

Microsoft's latest move is a leaf out Chrome's book, with auto-updates now being almost silently applied. We'll have to wait and see if the company decides a similar rapid release cycle however, though in the past, it has been vehemently opposed to it. **d**

YouTube redesigned, targets students

YouTube has received a major design overhaul, aimed at making the popular video sharing site much simpler to use. The overhauled YouTube now has a new home page with a greyish background, similar to other recently updated Google products.

YouTube's Channel page has received one of its biggest updates since its launch, helping users find more relevant videos. You can also browse recommended channels, personalise home page feeds and link up to social networks such as Google+ and Facebook. Personalised YouTube channel line-ups on the new left panel of the YouTube homepage is one of the newer features. In view of different goals of the uploaders, YouTube has also added an improved Channel templates feature.

The home page feed has been pushed to the centre of the page, letting users switch easily between different channels.

The video sharing site also launched YouTube for Schools, a new service targeted at institutions of learning, featuring educational videos with no distractions and only relevant content being shown. It can be found at youtube.com/schools. Google aims to deliver a platform where teachers would be able to show their students the "vast array of educational videos on YouTube," without being worried about distractions in the form of irrelevant or inappropriate recommended videos.

The new service is more "a network setting for school administrators," restricting access to educational content only. This includes subject-aligned playlists from more than 600 partners, including MIT, Smithsonian and TED, content that was previously also found on the YouTube EDU site, along with university-level content. YouTube for Schools will launch with more than 300 subject playlists from English to Science, sorted by grade level. This can be found at youtube.com/teachers. Teachers can also suggest their own playlists. **d**

